3. Cruciferous vegetables

The Brassica (Brassicaceae) family includes cruciferous vegetables such as cabbage, broccoli, kale, turnips, cauliflower, and brussels sprouts. These contain flavones and indoles which are thought to have anti-cancer activities.

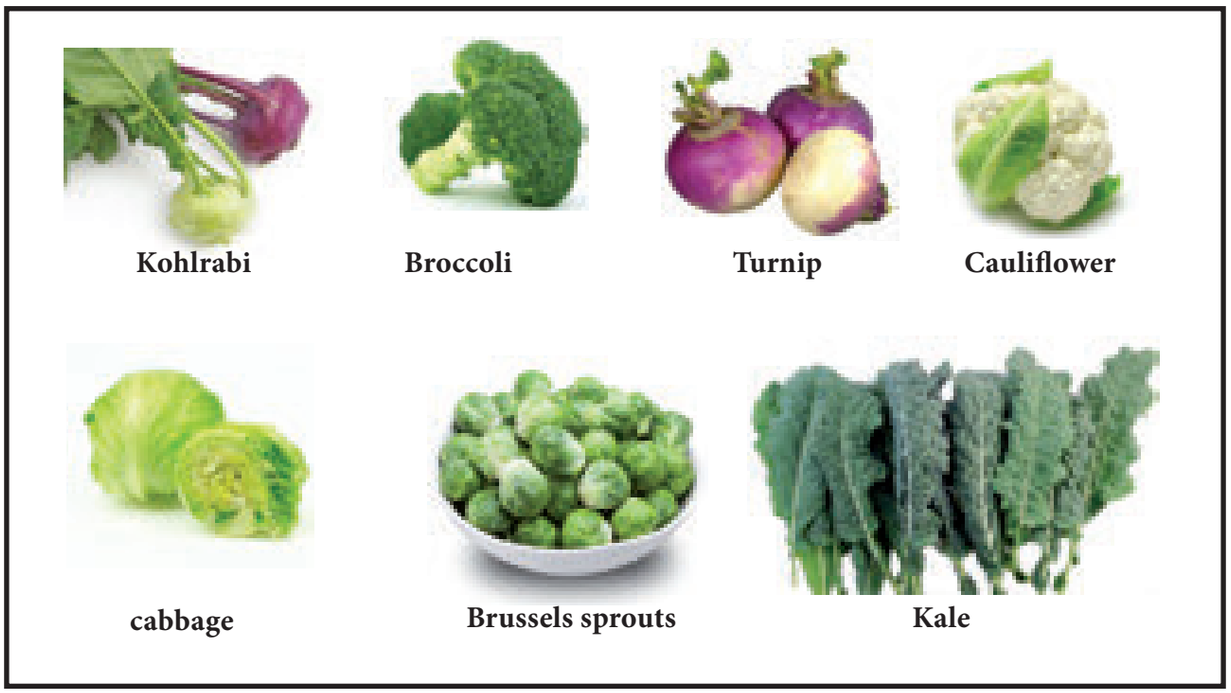


Fig 12.8 Cruciferous vegetables of the Brassica family

Activity : 2

Prepare a rainbow salad rich in antioxidants and phytonutrients by choosing vegetables and fruits of different colours.



4. Fibre intake

Dietary fibre increases stool bulk and speeds the transit of food through the colon, thus reducing the absorption of carcinogens.

Bile acids are secreted into the intestine to help digest fat. There, bacteria act on the bile acids and produce chemicals which may promote colon cancer. Dietary fibre binds with these bile acids and expels them from the intestines.

12.12 General recommendations to prevent cancer

- Reusing cooking oil is very harmful to health. Carcinogenic aldehydes form when the same cooking oil is reused.
- Frying, broiling, or grilling meat at very high temperatures forms chemicals such as polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbons and heterocyclic aromatic amines that are potent carcinogens. Limiting the intake of such foods is recommended to reduce cancer risk.

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